



Lighttpd and SQLite:

A Lightweight Web Server and Database Platform

This article demonstrates the setting up of a lightweight Web server and database platform, using the Lighttpd Web server and the SQLite database management system (DMS) instead of the LAMP stack. These two tools can effectively replace Apache and MySQL in situations where the full capabilities of these DMSs are not required, or where computational resources are scarce. The article assumes familiarity with PHP and SQL. Familiarity with PHP's PDO library will also be useful.

The combination of Apache and MySQL has become the de-facto standard in Web and database servers on GNU/Linux systems—so much so that the acronym LAMP (Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP) is commonly used to refer to this particular set of tools in the context of Web development. The Apache Web server is rightly regarded as one of the best, and it has proved its reliability on countless websites hosted all over the globe. It has accumulated a lot of useful features over

the years, enhancing its professional value even more. There is a tendency among users, however, to under-utilise computer hardware and software. Although the Apache Web server provides much functionality, there are many cases where much of its plethora of features simply remains unused. Also, often there are not enough computational resources available to run a large software application. For example, having just a low-end computer or a small mobile computing device should not be an